14. THE FACE

DURATION : 05:11

STUDY SHEET

COURSE SUMMARY

In this captivating video, we delve into the osteopathic approach to the face, based on embryological understanding and the importance of the environment in our bodily reorganisation. Students will learn to connect the mandibular arches to the base of the skull, while exploring the role of the glandular, circulatory, and neurological systems in facial balance. This training emphasises the dynamic interplay between the face and brain development, and the importance of the sphenobasilar symphysis in promoting deep healing. Participants will also be made aware of the complex processes of the neural crest and their impact on our overall health, integrating a practical approach to treating hyper- and hypomobilities related to these structures.

THE FACE: OSTEOPATHIC APPROACH AND EMBRYOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENT

In this course, we will explore the **osteopathic practice** of the face, adopting a **holistic approach**. This means that we do not focus solely on specific areas, but we take into account the environment around us, as this environment plays a crucial role in our reorganisation.

The **face** is an indirect reflection of the **neural crest**, a tissue that receives and transmits information through a complex network in the body. This network is present in both **peripheral** and **visceral** areas. Thus, the face expresses the interior and, in turn, informs the interior.

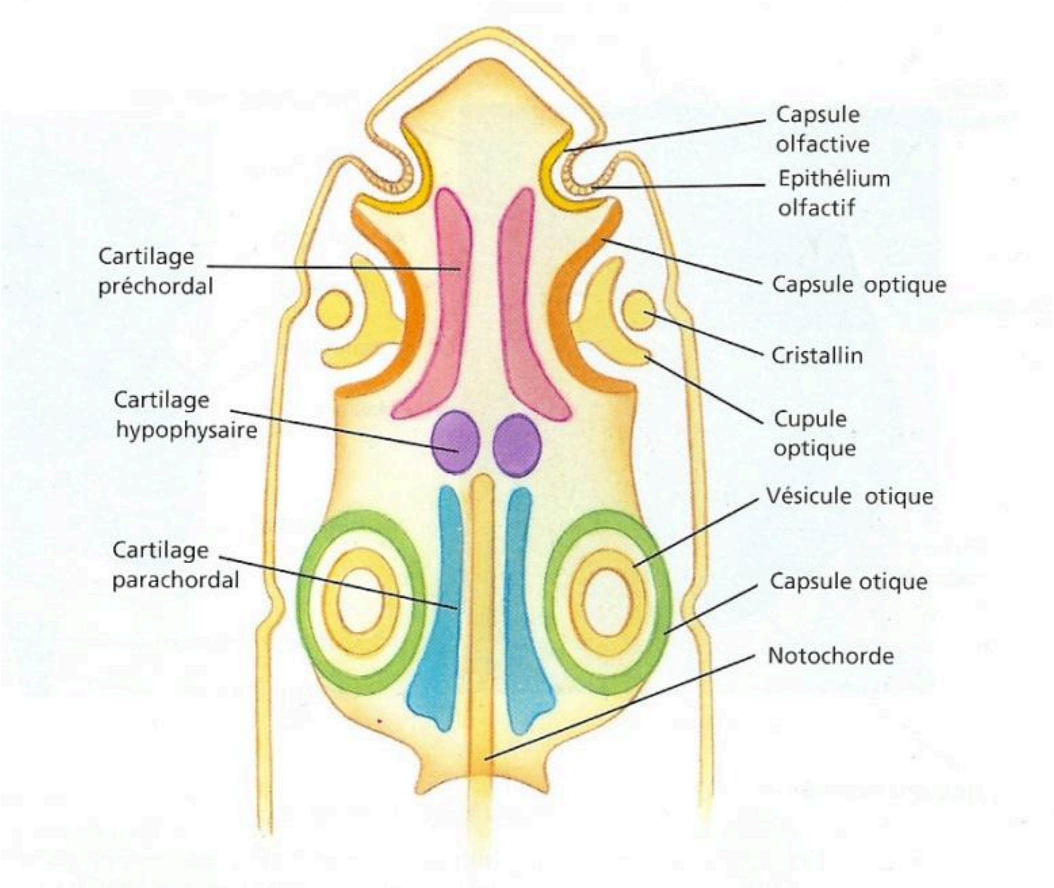


FIG. — Vertebrate embryonic head

During embryonic formation, the **mandibular arches** develop from branchial pouches, creating lines of force that orient towards the **base of the skull**. This base receives a convergence of facial information, influencing the **glandular**, **circulatory**, **lymphatic**, and even the **neurological** systems. It is essential to understand that this base of the skull represents a balance between the **neurocranium** and the **viscerocranium**, and that all information is integrated there.

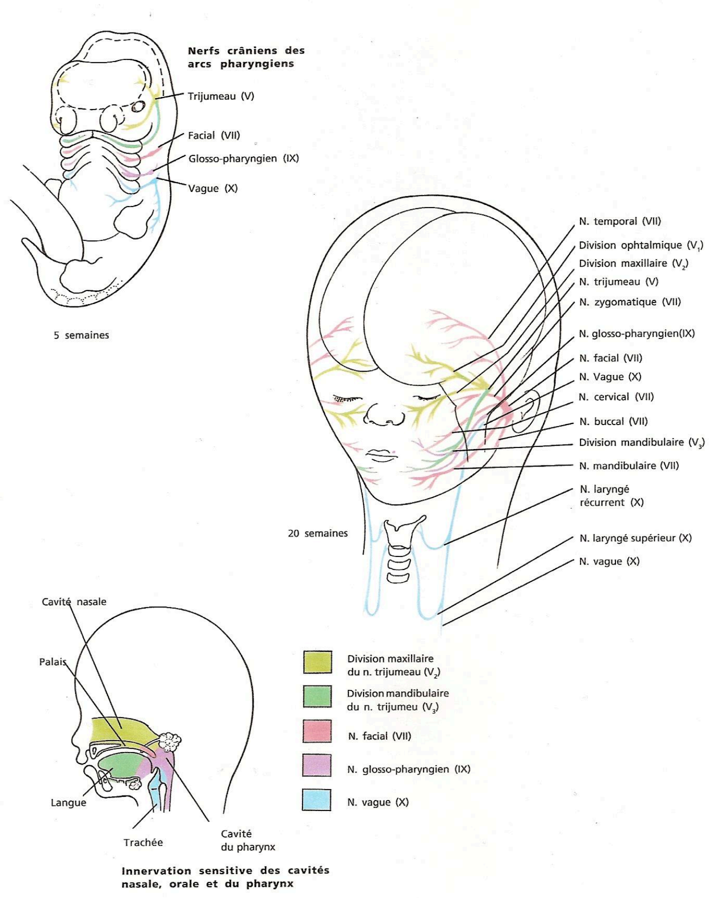


FIG. — Development of cephalic innervation

We will also examine how to rebalance the **sphenobasilar symphysis** on a tensional and osteopathic level. A dysfunctional thyroid can lead to **hypomobilities**. It is important to remember that in the healing process, it is always about **taking** and **giving**. People who suffer from congestion are often those who cannot give.

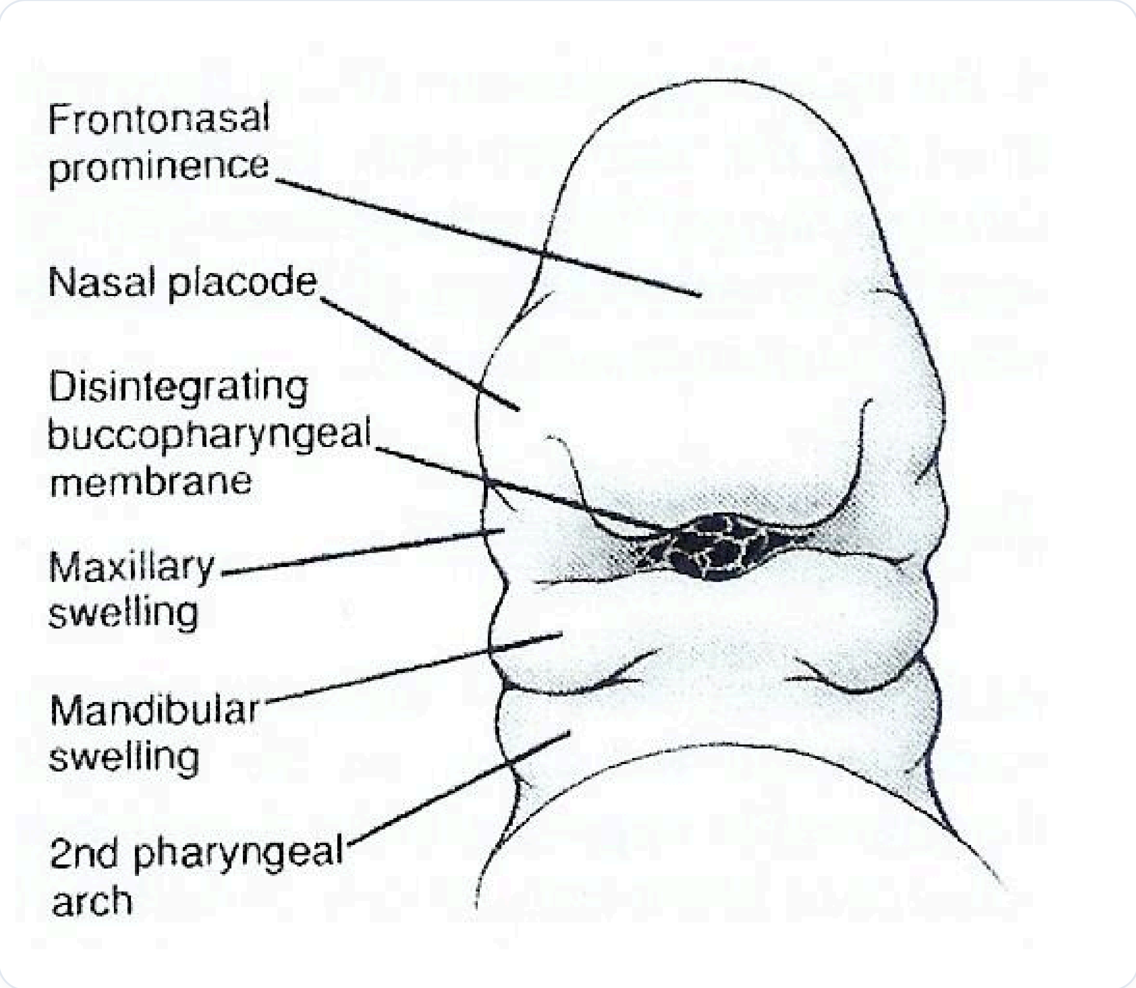


FIG. — Embryonic facial development

The dynamics of the face are linked to brain development. Initially, the brain consists of a **prosencephalon** and other structures. The prosencephalon develops by forming two lateral spheres that hypertrophy, creating a dynamic movement. This movement allows for the formation of the **frontal bone** and the left and right hemispheres.

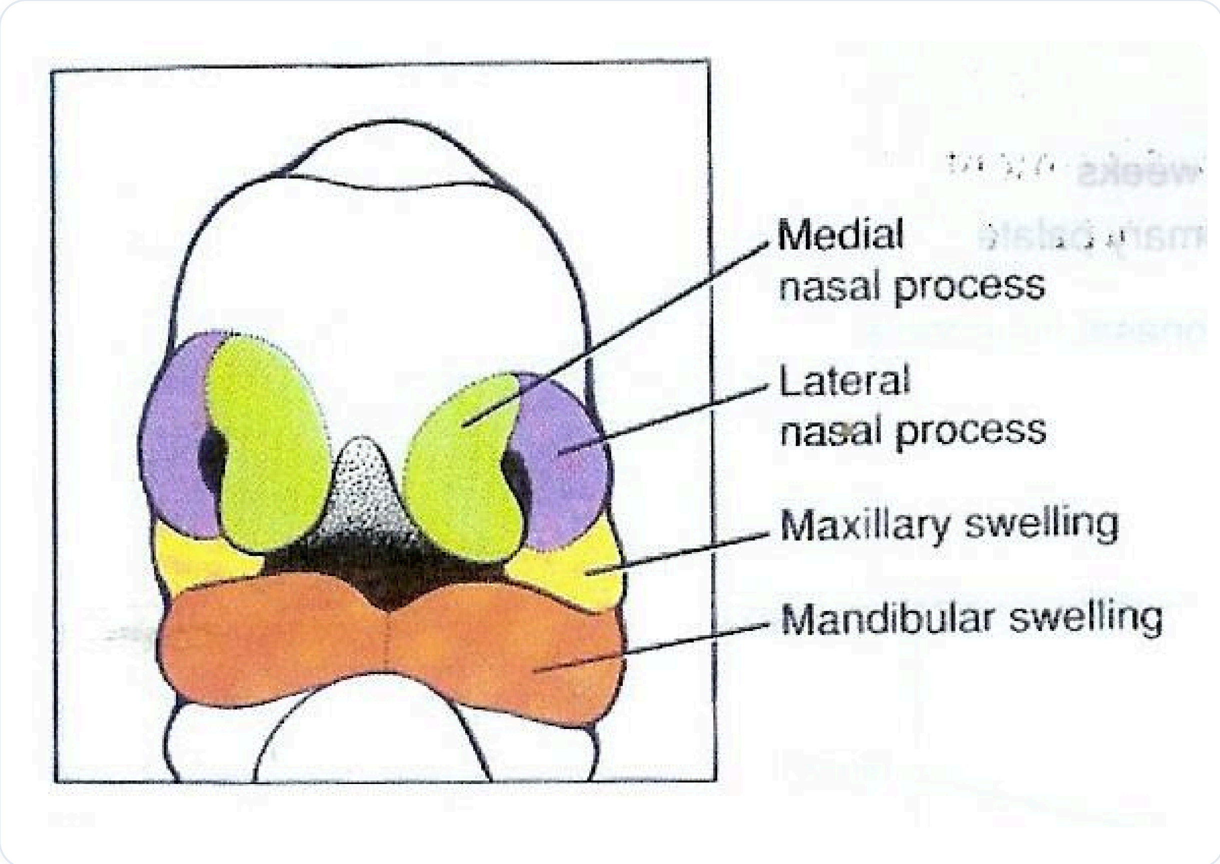


FIG. — Early facial development

As this development progresses, the face, initially compressed between the heart and the brain, opens into space. The lateral areas, such as the **optic placode** and the **nasal placode**, integrate towards the midline, thus forming a midline of anticipation.

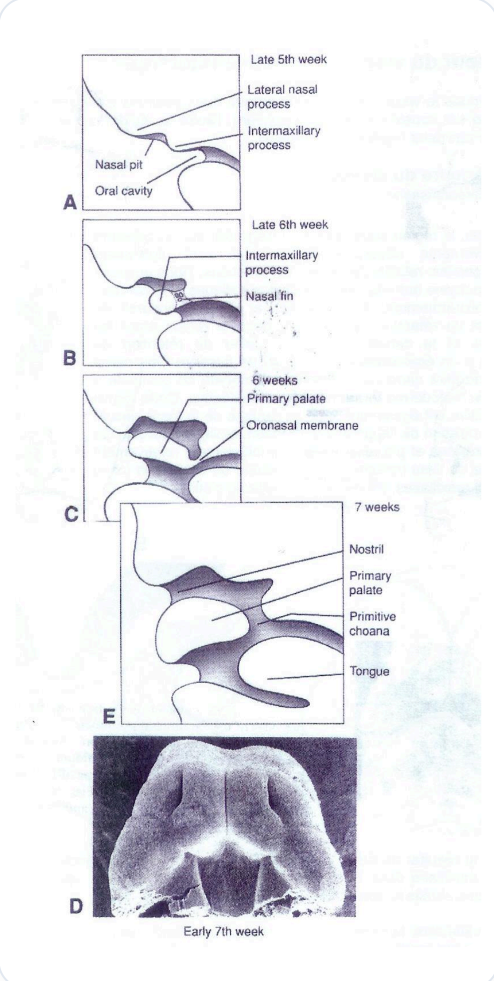


FIG. — *Primary palate development*

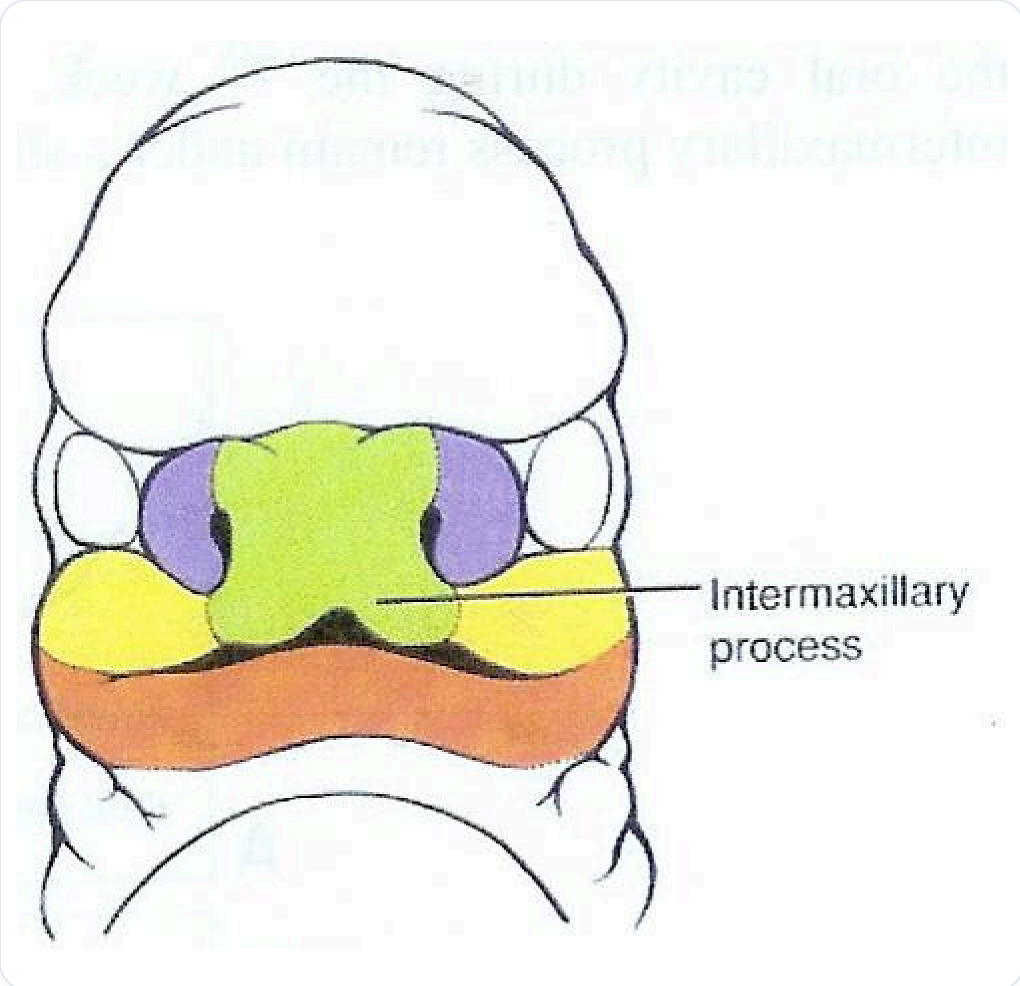
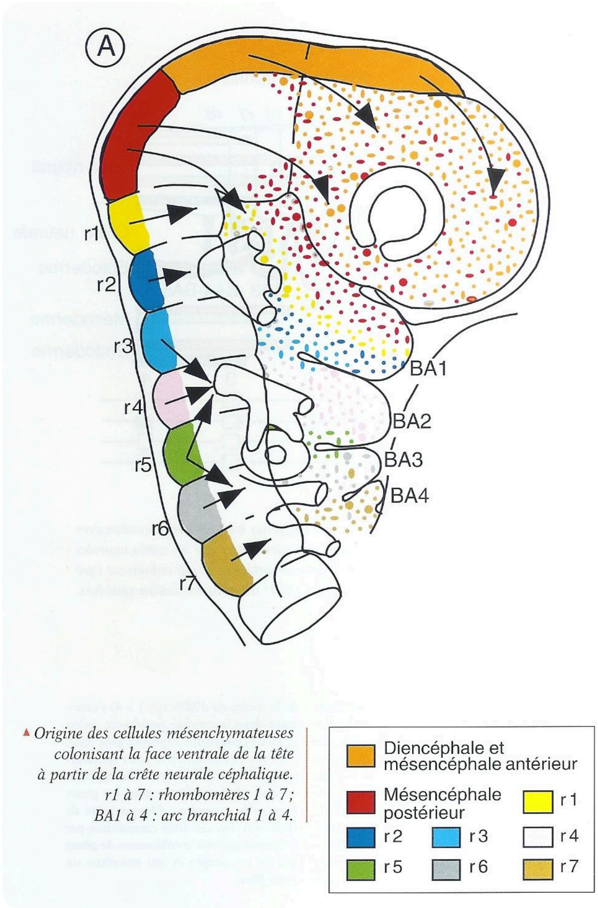


FIG. — Embryonic facial development

We also observe the **flow of the neural crest**, which extends from the posterior **mesencephalon** and invades the **mesoderm** to form **mesectoderm**. This integration process occurs simultaneously with brain development and the organisation of the **dural sheaths**.



Origine des cellules mésenchymateuses colonisant la face ventrale de la tête à partir de la crête neurale céphalique. r1 à 7 : rhombomères 1 à 7 ; BA1 à 4 : arc branchial 1 à 4.

FIG. *— Neural crest migration*

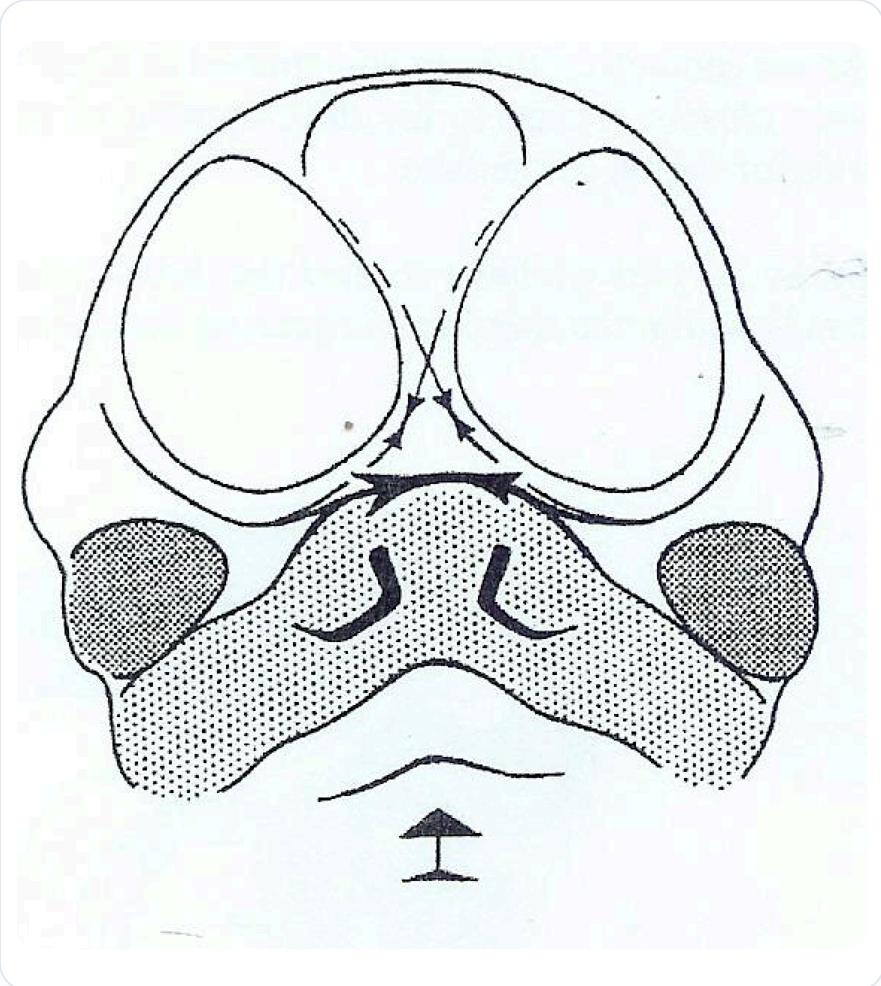


FIG. *— Human developmental facial morphogenesis*

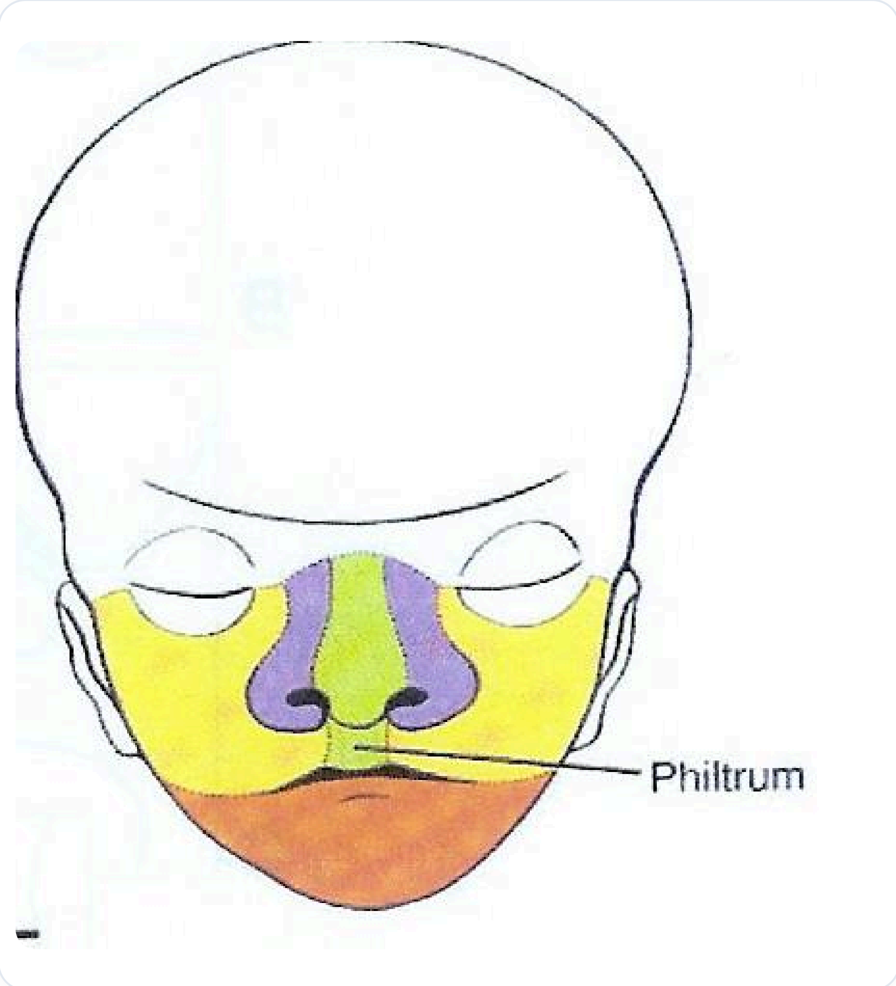


FIG. — Embryonic facial development

Finally, it is important to note that the area from superficial to deep, represented by the mesectoderm, includes the skin, muscles, bones, and other structures such as the cornea. This integration is essential for understanding the complexity of the face and its role in our overall health.

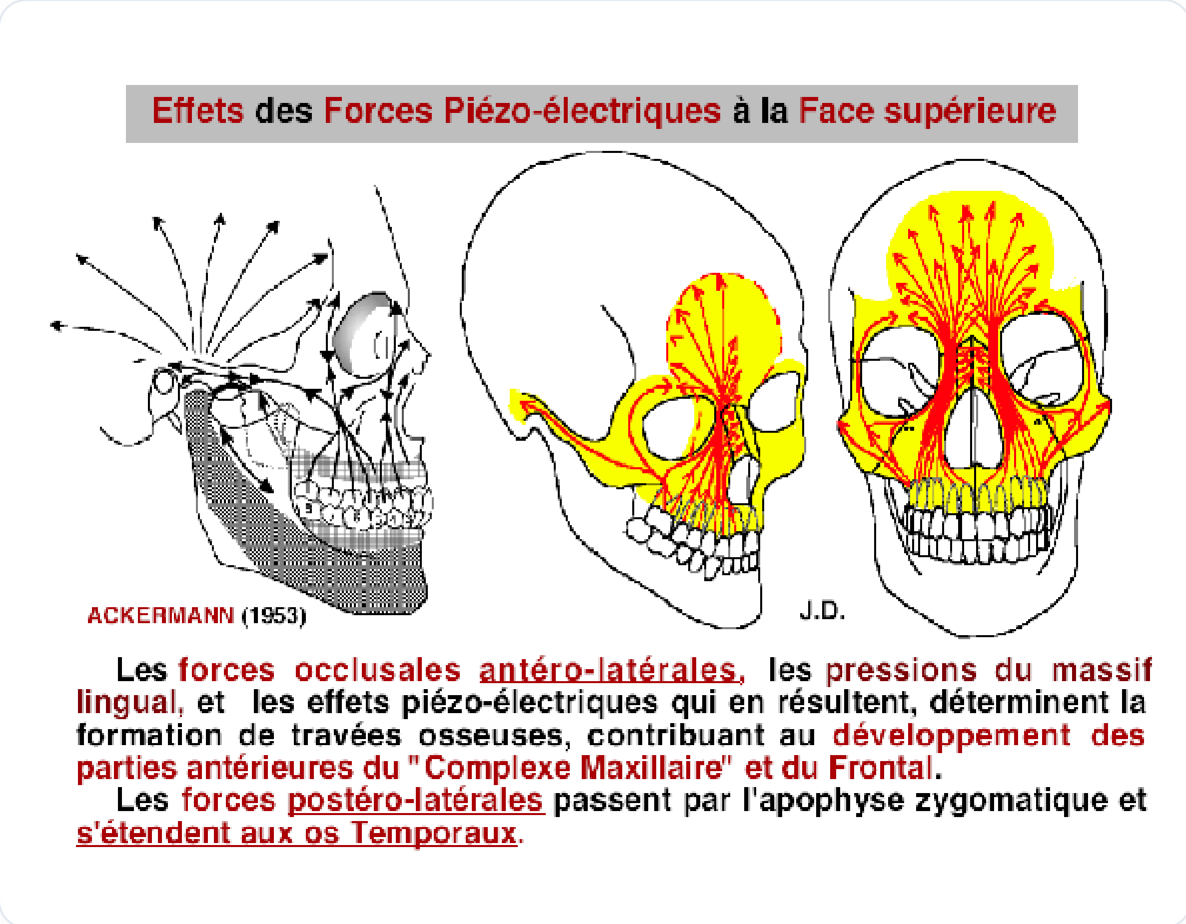


FIG. — Cranial piezoelectric forces